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Unit 2 Reflection

From the MVC refactoring assignment, I learned about the MVC design structure and about the real benefits of organizing code this way. Here's a more specific description of what I've learned:

Model:

Model is the data layer. This is the layer where data is stored and where functions related to data retrieval are stored. I found it very useful to move data retrieval functions to this model! For our project, the faculty and course data resided in the data layer.

View:

View is the presentation layer. If the user sees it, it will be in the view layer. This layer contains the ejs templates and the logic specifically related to populating the templates.

Controllers:

The controller layer is the linking layer. The controller layer maps directly to the request response cycle. The controller layer gets requests from the view layer, makes decisions within the controller layer, may call data retrieval functions from the model layer, and may render templates from the view layer.

We also learned about route parameters and query parameters and how to work with them in Express.

Query Parameters:

Query Parameters are the tail end of the url and should be used to control things like appearance or sorting.

Route Parameters:

Route parameters are typically at the center of the url and dictate the structure of the url. Learning about route parameters was fun because it helped me realize how complex urls like GitHub can be achieved. Prior to this, I looked at "<https://github.com/haroldsen/>" and wondered how "haroldsen" worked in the url.

My Team:

Everyone is doing well on communication. James was proactive. When he was sick, he messaged before class and communicated that he would do what needed to be done.

I don't have any concerns about contribution at this point. I'm sure that could change when we dive into the team project. As for now, I have no reason to believe there will be participation issues.

Ellie is proactive in getting the readings done early.